TESSA Offline

Installation & User Guide | macOS and Windows

A local educational artifact for SMEs navigating the EU AI Act.

A. What is TESSA Offline?

TESSA Offline is a locally operated educational AI artifact designed to help small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) understand EU AI Act concepts, likely risk categories, operator roles, and relevant governance actions. It combines a local language model with a curated knowledge package and retrieves supporting passages when answering questions.

The artifact uses Ollama for local model inference and AnythingLLM Desktop for the user interface and document retrieval. No ChatGPT account or OpenAI API key is required. Internet access is needed for initial software/model downloads; after setup, local questions can work without internet.

Important: TESSA provides educational information, not legal advice. The packaged knowledge cut-off is 18 March 2026. Verify consequential legal conclusions against current official legislation and qualified advice.

B. Before you begin

System requirements

- macOS or Windows computer supported by the downloaded versions of Ollama and AnythingLLM Desktop.
- Reference model qwen3:14b: aim for at least 16 GB RAM, preferably more; actual performance depends on available memory and hardware.
- Allow approximately 25–30 GB free storage for software, model and documents; more may be required.
- Internet connection for downloading the software and local model; administrator rights may be needed for installation.

Files in the TESSA package

- TESSA-Configuration/TESSA-Configuration.txt and TESSA-System-Prompt.txt
- TESSA-Knowledge/ (9 distributed source files, including the Article 26 PDF)

- Install-TESSA/macOS/ and Install-TESSA/Windows/ scripts (optional)
- Installation-Guide/ and Licence-Information/

Note: The number of source files in the package may differ from the number of indexed workspace documents. Confirm that supported documents are added to the workspace and retrievable.

C. Step 1 — Extract the package

1. Copy the TESSA Offline release-candidate ZIP onto the computer.
2. Extract the ZIP to a regular folder, such as Documents/TESSA-Offline-Setup. Do not work directly inside the compressed archive.
3. Locate TESSA-Configuration, TESSA-Knowledge and Install-TESSA.

D. Step 2 — Install Ollama and AnythingLLM

macOS

4. Download Ollama for macOS from https://ollama.com/download and install it.
5. Open Ollama and keep it running.
6. Download AnythingLLM Desktop from https://anythingllm.com/desktop; install and open it. Version 1.16.0 is the documented reference version.

Windows

7. Download Ollama for Windows from https://ollama.com/download and install it.
8. Start Ollama and confirm it is running in the background.
9. Download and install AnythingLLM Desktop from https://anythingllm.com/desktop; open it. Version 1.16.0 is the documented reference version.

E. Step 3 — Download a local AI model

Open Terminal (macOS) or PowerShell (Windows) and run:

ollama pull qwen3:14b

This is the TESSA reference model. Wait for the download to finish; it may take time depending on network speed.

Alternative for low-memory computers — experimental

One Windows pilot tester reported that qwen3:14b was too large for their PC and that moondream:latest ran quickly. To try that model instead:

ollama pull moondream:latest

Moondream is primarily a vision-language model, not a validated replacement for legal question answering. Successful operation does not establish answer quality, legal accuracy, or equivalence to qwen3:14b. Record the chosen model in the test log. Consider a smaller text-focused model for future evaluation.

Optional setup scripts can help download the reference model, but they do not automatically configure the TESSA workspace. Manual setup is supported on both platforms.

F. Step 4 — Configure AnythingLLM

In AnythingLLM Desktop, configure the model provider and local retrieval settings. Menu labels may vary by application version.

LLM provider	Ollama
Ollama endpoint	http://127.0.0.1:11434
LLM model	qwen3:14b (reference) or recorded experimental alternative
Model context window	4096
Embedding provider	AnythingLLM Embedder
Embedding model	all-MiniLM-L6-v2
Vector database	LanceDB

If the model is not listed, verify Ollama is running and that the model was downloaded successfully. Save the settings.

G. Step 5 — Create the TESSA workspace

10. Create a new workspace named TESSA Offline.
11. Open its settings. Set Chat Mode to Query and Chat History to 20.
12. Set Search Preference to Accuracy Optimized, Maximum Context Snippets to 20, and Document Similarity Threshold to No restriction, where these controls are available.

13. Open TESSA-Configuration/TESSA-System-Prompt.txt; copy the entire file into the workspace System Prompt field, then save.

Do not substitute an older backup prompt. The release prompt should prioritize Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 for binding legal requirements.

H. Step 6 — Import the knowledge package

14. Open the document management area in AnythingLLM.
15. Upload supported documents from TESSA-Knowledge. Some file types, including spreadsheets, may need conversion or separate handling depending on the application version.
16. Add the processed documents to the TESSA Offline workspace; uploading alone may not enable retrieval.
17. Wait until document processing and embedding complete, then confirm the documents appear as workspace sources.

The package includes the EU AI Act, Article 26, Article 55, the TESSA guidance book, Commission GPAI guidelines, and use-case/reference materials. Do not claim all nine files are indexed unless verified in the interface.

I. Step 7 — Test with internet connected

18. Start a new thread in TESSA Offline.
19. Ask: “What is the EU AI Act?”
20. Check that a response appears, uses local sources, and includes appropriate uncertainty and citations.
21. Ask: “What are the obligations of deployers of high-risk AI systems under Article 26?” Check completeness and article references; a generated response may still be incomplete or inaccurate.

J. Step 8 — Test without internet

22. Keep Ollama and AnythingLLM running. Disconnect Wi-Fi and other internet access.
23. Start a fresh conversation and repeat an EU AI Act question.
24. Confirm a response is generated and local source passages are retrieved.
25. Record the operating system, model, RAM, outcome, and any error messages. Reconnect internet afterward if desired.

A successful offline response proves basic local functionality, not that the installation is reproducible or that all legal guidance is correct.

K. Troubleshooting

Ollama model unavailable	Start Ollama; run ollama list; pull the selected model again if necessary.
Slow response / out of memory	Close other applications; check RAM; consider an experimental smaller text model and separately validate accuracy.
No document citations	Verify the documents were processed and added to the workspace, not merely uploaded.
PowerShell script blocked	Use the manual ollama pull command rather than changing system-wide execution policy.
Incorrect article references	Check retrieved source passages; log the issue for legal accuracy review.
No offline response	Check that model inference, embeddings and document storage are configured locally.

L. Pilot test record

Platform / OS version	_____
Installed RAM / free storage	_____
Model and version	_____
Install date / tester	_____
Online response / sources	Pass / Partial / Fail
Offline response / sources	Pass / Partial / Fail
Problems or notes	_____

M. Release limitations and support

This document describes a guided installation, not a one-click installer. A supervised Windows installation and an offline test on an existing Mac have been reported; independent clean installation,

multilingual performance, legal accuracy and redistribution rights still require review before public release.

Project information and future updates: https://tessa.gpt-lab.eu

N. Contact and Support

TESSA Offline — SME EU AI Act artefact

Developed by GPT-Lab, Tampere University, Finland.

For installation support, technical issues, feedback, or collaboration inquiries, please contact:

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When reporting an issue, please include your operating system (Windows/macOS), selected AI model, and a brief description of the problem.

Note: TESSA Offline is an educational AI governance artefact. Its responses do not constitute legal advice.